

John Leonard — SIGGA Director of Product Management

Recruiter Screening Questions — Prepared Responses

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QUESTION 1 — SAAS PRODUCTS MANAGED

Can you describe the SaaS products you have managed and your role in defining product strategy, roadmap prioritization, and customer adoption? What business outcomes were you responsible for?

I've spent the last eight years leading product strategy across a GovTech procurement platform that competed directly with SAP Ariba in the public sector — serving large state and local government agencies operating under strict regulatory and compliance requirements. The platform suite included eProcurement, contract lifecycle management, supplier marketplace, cooperative contract reconciliation, and bid management products serving 500,000+ users and over one million suppliers across North America.

At Periscope Holdings, I owned the full strategy-to-launch cycle for three net-new products. A transaction-based cooperative contract reconciliation platform that enabled \$18M in new customer revenue. A supplier portal rebuild that expanded subscriptions 17%. And a government-first enterprise contract-sharing marketplace built and launched in nine months. I also owned the SAP integration for our eProcurement product — a critical enterprise integration for agencies running procurement workflows inside SAP environments.

When Periscope was acquired by mdf Commerce and later rebranded as SOVRA, I was retained and expanded into a portfolio leadership role. I built and led a team of 30 — including Product Owners, UX/UI, Data Platform, Scrum Masters, and Tech Writers — and hired two Directors to lead the PMO and data practice. I also established the company's first Tech PMO, onboarding 100+ globally distributed offshore contributors and creating the operating model that aligned delivery to executive priorities, AI strategy, and customer commitments. Across that period I governed roadmap and delivery across five platforms and 20+ products, led a \$10M capital improvement program spanning 50+ initiatives, and maintained stability across \$75M ARR while integrating AI capabilities into the product line.

Across all of it I was accountable for business outcomes: ARR retention, customer adoption, release velocity, and cross-functional alignment across product, engineering, sales, and customer success.

QUESTION 2 — AI-ENABLED PRODUCTS

Have you led the development of AI-enabled products or features? Please describe the solutions you helped create, your role in defining the strategy and execution, and the business value or outcomes these initiatives delivered.

Yes — and this is an area I've invested in deeply, both in my day job and through independent applied research.

At SOVRA, I led AI feature integration across the portfolio as part of our \$10M capital improvement program. One concrete example: I introduced LLM-assisted requirements and design generation into our product development workflow, compressing the design-to-engineering handoff from weeks to days. I also architected the strategy for a lakehouse data platform — unifying 14TB of product and user data — specifically to enable AI-driven product capabilities and future data monetization. AI wasn't a feature we bolted on; it was a deliberate architectural layer I planned from the data foundation up.

Beyond my corporate roles, I designed and directed the build of DeepBench — a production multi-agent AI workforce platform — as a non-coder product executive. It is live and continuously shipping. The system includes multi-agent orchestration with specialized domain analyst agents, a RAG pipeline with semantic vector retrieval, a ReAct autonomous web agent that perceives, decides, acts, and writes knowledge back to a database — self-improving without retraining — and an LLM evaluation framework with per-step confidence scoring and full agent run logs for auditability.

The reason I built it: I believe the next generation of enterprise software — including industrial asset management — will be built around AI agents performing complex domain work. I wanted to be able to architect and direct that, not just describe it. DeepBench is the proof. For a company like SIGGA, where the opportunity is embedding AI into SAP-native maintenance and field workforce workflows, that combination of enterprise product leadership and hands-on AI architecture fluency is the direct value I'd bring.

The platform is live at deepbench.roadmapventure.com.

QUESTION 3 — SAP / EAM SOLUTIONS

Have you had direct, hands-on experience with SAP, Enterprise Asset Management (EAM) solutions, or industrial environments, rather than just exposure to these areas? If so, please describe your role and the industries or customers you supported.

My honest answer is that my SAP and EAM experience is adjacent rather than deep — and I'd rather be direct about that than oversell it.

On the SAP side: I owned the SAP integration for our eProcurement platform at Periscope, which required understanding how government agencies ran procurement workflows inside SAP environments and how our product needed to connect to and complement that infrastructure. SAP Ariba was our primary enterprise competitor, so I spent years understanding that ecosystem from a product and customer displacement perspective.

On the asset management side: earlier in my career, before moving into SaaS product leadership, I was a GIS systems consultant implementing municipal technology for the City of Kansas City. That work included implementing and integrating Intergraph's MGE platform — one of the early enterprise asset management systems used for municipal infrastructure — as well as Accela, an ERP and permitting platform for city operations, for which I wrote the GIS integration layer. Those were hands-on implementations in regulated government operational environments.

What I don't have is direct experience inside mining, energy, utilities, or manufacturing — the industrial verticals SIGGA serves. I want to name that clearly. What I do bring is 20+ years of building software for complex operational workflows in highly regulated environments, a track record of rapidly entering new domains and delivering outcomes, and the AI architecture depth to help SIGGA build the next generation of intelligent maintenance capabilities — which based on the job description appears to be a core part of what this role is meant to drive.

I'm a fast domain learner — my track record across GovTech, procurement, IP commercialization, background screening, and AI platforms reflects that consistently. I'm confident the SAP and industrial context would come quickly, and I'd bring immediate value on the product strategy, AI roadmap, and team leadership dimensions from day one.